

The quotes are important here, you need to type them! This will install the latest version of Django that came before 1.9, which means you will get the latest patched version of Django 1.8

Starting a New Django Project

Django projects need to follow a specific project structure, and Django includes the ‘django-admin’ command that amongst providing many other features also includes a subcommand ‘startproject’ to create this structure for you.

To create a new project called ‘mycms’ in the current directory, run:

django-admin startproject mycms

This will create the following project structure:

Name	Size	Type
mycms	4 items	folder
__init__.py	0 B	Python script
settings.py	2.6 KiB	Python script
urls.py	755 B	Python script
wsgi.py	387 B	Python script
manage.py	248 B	Python script

django-newproject

Let’s look at this structure in detail.

The newly created ‘mycms’ directory contains two entireties, a manage.py file and yet another directory called mycms. The ‘manage.py’ command allows us to perform administrative tasks on our project. The ‘mycms’ directory contains configuration code for our project.

The ‘settings.py’ file, as its name suggests, contains the configuration settings for our project. In this file you will find configuration parameters such as your project path, template and static file paths and urls, your database settings and included applications, time zones etc. For our purposes most of the default settings will work just fine, including the default database settings.

By default Django applications are configured to use a file-based SQLite3 database for storing data. You can see this setting defined as ‘DATABASES = ...’ in the settings file. Note the plural, Django can use multiple databases of different types in the same app!